



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John's Classical Academy

School Website: <https://stjca.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Johns Classical Academy Florida (SJCA) presents a clearly classical-inflected profile rooted in virtue, truth, and beauty, with explicit aims toward forming virtuous citizens through a classical, content-rich curriculum. Public materials emphasize a Western classical heritage, a community ethos centered on character and civic responsibility, and a motto built around the transcendental triad of truth, goodness, and beauty. The school's stated mission and culture plan highlight formation of mind and character, rather than mere job-readiness, and portray teachers modeling virtue and students engaging in thoughtful discussion. Taken together, SJCA shows strong alignment with several core elements of classical education, especially in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose/Goal, and Faculty/Community orientation. Yet some classical-signaling elements—such as explicit Great Books / Trivium pedagogy, visible liturgical practices, and documented, high-fidelity classical pedagogy across all grades—are less clearly enumerated in public-facing materials. Consequently, SJCA sits toward the middle-to-upper end of the Classical spectrum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with several robust Classical cues and a few areas where public materials could more explicitly codify all six elements of a full classical model.

Key takeaways at a glance:

- Strong Classical signaling in Foundational beliefs and goals (truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, Western classical heritage), plus explicit formation language and civic aims. This supports CLASSICAL in Categories 1 and 2.
- Curriculum signaling is present but not uniformly explicit about all classical milestones (e.g., Great Books / Trivium pedagogy is not consistently spelled out in public materials), creating a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reading for Element 3.
- Pedagogy shows some classical signals (e.g., Great Conversations appears in a school calendar reference), but lacks consistently explicit articulation of Socratic seminars or scholé rhythms across all grade bands in the material available to us, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 4.
- Faculty messaging aligns with classical ideals (teachers as living curriculum, modeling virtue); Element 5 leans CLASSICAL.
- Parent/community signals exist, with emphasis on partnership and a values-centric culture, but explicit statements about parents as co-teachers or ongoing parent-formation programs are less evident, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 6.
- Overall, SJCA would move toward full CLASSICAL with targeted clarifications and expansions around: Great Books / Trivium emphasis, explicit Socratic pedagogy across grades, liturgical/community practices, and stronger parent-formation messaging.

This assessment draws on:

- SJCA public materials (school site content and documents) from the school-specific crawl vector store, including mission statements, culture plans, and scheduling references that show a classical orientation and core virtues. See evidence from the SJCA materials, including mission and culture text that foreground truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue, and explicit motto statements.
- The classical-education knowledge base (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School) for the rubric and keyword lists (positive/negative indicators) used to evaluate each category. See the explicit Positive Keywords and Negative Keywords for each category, and the accompanying lexicon that lists core classical indicators (e.g., truth, virtue, Great Books, Scholé, Socratic pedagogy, etc.).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's public materials emphasize a culture grounded in truth, goodness, and beauty, inspired by the Western classical tradition, and reference a nine-virtue framework (Citizenship, Courage, Honesty, Humility, Integrity, Perseverance, Respect, Responsibility, Wisdom). This is stated in the mission and culture texts, where the motto and culture statements explicitly anchor character formation in transcendent ideals.
- The motto "Learn the True, Do the Good, Love the Beautiful" functions as a lived-metaphysical orientation (transcendental ideals made concrete in daily practice). The same source notes the Western classical tradition as the cultural backbone.
- The Hillsdale-affiliated framing and the emphasis on virtuous living align with transcendental/teleological aims and moral realism in classical education lexicons.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; moral/ethical formation; classical tradition; great conversation (as an implicit aim in virtuous culture); formation of the soul (implied by character-and-mind emphasis). The public materials repeatedly invoke truth, goodness, beauty and virtue as central aims.
- Negative keywords present: minimal or no signals of relativism, secular humanism, or anti-theistic trends; the public materials lean away from value-neutral stances. The absence of explicit secular/neutral language supports the positive alignment. (Basis in the Six Essential Elements negative keyword set; no explicit alignment with relativism or secular humanism found in the public SJCA materials.)

Why this rating

- The presence of transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue-driven formation, plus a Western classical framework, strongly signals a Classical orientation for foundational metaphysical aims. The lack of explicit theology-laden or liturgical practice statements in the publicly available text lowers this from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in strict rubric terms, but the overall orientation remains solidly classical in spirit.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements emphasize formation of mind and character through a classical, content-rich curriculum, aimed at virtuous living and civic responsibility; the language explicitly de-emphasizes mere job-prep in favor of human formation and virtue. This aligns with the classical aim to cultivate virtue and wisdom rather than only employability.
- The motto and culture statements foreground true knowledge, virtuous living, and beauty, reinforcing the transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) as real ends of education. The public-facing materials present the aim as forming intelligent, virtuous American citizens.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education (implicitly via "classical, content-rich curriculum"), telos/pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, contemplation/rest in the form of Scholé-like orientation (mentioned in classical lexicons as a marker of formation and non-primarily job-focused aims).
- Negative keywords present: explicit workforce-preparation or 21st-century skills language is not present in the public materials; no strong signals indicating "career-readiness" as the ultimate goal appear. This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The school frames education as formation and character development with a high regard for truth/-goodness/beauty, rather than solely for job market metrics. This aligns with the Classical School goal as described in the knowledge-base rubric.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SJCA describes its curriculum as a classical, content-rich program, with a focus on tradition and virtue; public text does not consistently spell out Great Books or the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) by name in the accessible site copy, though the Curriculum is framed within a classical context. The school's own materials emphasize "classical, content-rich curriculum" and Western classical heritage, which signals alignment to core classical ideals, but the explicit mention of Great Books and the Trivium is not clearly documented in the visible public materials.
- A reference from the school's materials to "Great Conversations" appears in a calendar entry (e.g., PLC/Great Conversations), suggesting some engagement with classical dialogue and primary texts, but not a comprehensive Great Books program stated across the curriculum in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements and lexicon): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books / Great Conversation; history as a core through-line; integration of history, literature, philosophy, and sciences; wonder and integration. The SJCA materials explicitly foreground "classical" curriculum and "Western classical tradition," and the Great Conversations/calendar entry hints at engagement with primary texts and sustained examination of ideas.
- Negative keywords present: The explicit mention of project-based, experiential, or STEM-first approaches as primary is not evident; however, those elements are not overtly present in the public materials and thus could be read as not signaling a strong anti-classical stance. The absence of clear Great Books/Trivium declarations lowers the rating toward SOMEWHAT rather than CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is described as classical and content-rich, with a Western classical heritage, but explicit documentation of the full Great Books emphasis and the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is not consistently present in the public site text. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, signaling a classical orientation with room for more explicit articulation of core classical curriculum elements.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Calendar entries reference "Great Conversations," indicating some engagement with classical discussion-practice and conversations around key texts or topics. This is a hallmark of higher-level classical pedagogy (upper-level Socratic-style discussion, seminars, etc.).
- The culture language emphasizes thoughtful discussion and virtue formation; while explicit Socratic seminars or Scholé days are not consistently described in the public text, the emphasis on character, virtue, and thoughtful discourse aligns with classical pedagogy norms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements pedg/Lexicon): Socratic dialogue/seminar; narration/recitation; restful learning (Scholé); upper-school rhetoric; praise for disciplined dialogue and "great conversation." The SJCA materials show "Great Conversations" scheduling, and the culture plan mentions thoughtful discussion, which aligns with a portion of the pedagogical lexicon.
- Negative keywords present: There is little public indication of heavy reliance on experiential or project-based pedagogy as the dominant approach; however, the precise balance of activities (Socratic

vs. project-based vs. lecture) is not fully specified in the public text. The absence of explicit, uniform Scholé rest and memory-based pedagogy across all grades lowers this toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The presence of “Great Conversations” and a focus on thoughtful, virtue-centered discourse signal classical pedagogy in parts of the program. However, the public-facing materials do not consistently spell out a full matrix of classic pedagogical methods (e.g., universal use of Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, or scholé across all grades). This partial signaling supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials emphasize that teachers lead by example and model virtue, and they describe teachers as mentors who form the living curriculum and the core of the school's culture. This aligns with the classical conception of faculty as moral exemplars and living curriculum.
- The organization's culture plan and communications emphasize a collegial, virtuous teacher presence and the notion of the faculty as a model for students—core classical signals. The lexicon used in the classical education literature identifies “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” and “living curriculum,” which align with SJCA's stated aims.
- The school's governance and staff materials (e.g., Board/Leadership) indicate a stable adult community and formal structure, consistent with the classical ideal of a mature, virtuous faculty guiding students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; masterful pedagogy and character formation. These map cleanly to Positive Keywords in Element 5 and to the classical lexicon's portrayal of teacher roles.
- Negative keywords present: none that signal a non-classical faculty design (e.g., “facilitator on the side” or non-credential-driven jargon). The absence of such negative signals supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on teachers as virtuous models, mentors, and the living curriculum, plus a collegial faculty culture, aligns strongly with the classical faculty ideal and justifies a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SJCA materials emphasize a culture of family involvement and a commitment to parents as part of building intelligent, virtuous citizens. The mission and culture materials reference “scholars, teachers, and families” united in a mission and describe a community atmosphere with respect and thoughtful discussion. This signals a partnership with parents and a community-wide classical ethos.
- The school's public materials reflect a community-oriented approach (e.g., community information nights, welcome for varied backgrounds, a focus on citizenship and civic responsibility), which aligns with the “partnership with families” and “formation of affections” signals in the classical education lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; formation of affections; cultural transmission; Western tradition; parental engagement; family involvement; communication with parents. Some of

these terms appear in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and in the Positive Keywords for Element 6. The SJCA materials show alignment with family involvement as part of the school culture.

- Negative keywords present: explicit statements that parents are “co-teachers” or formal parent-formation programs are not clearly shown in public text; there is no clear, explicit programmatic content for parent-formation or a robust “open campus”/parent-co-teacher messaging beyond general partnership signals. The absence of those explicit structural programs reduces the score from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for this category.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly indicate partnership with families and a family-centric culture, but the absence of explicit, structured parent-formation programs or formal “parents as co-teachers” messaging lowers Element 6 from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall, the school's profile sits squarely in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range, with strong CLASSICAL signals in Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Faculty, and more cautious signals in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parents & Community, which would benefit from more explicit documentation of Great Books / Trivium-oriented curriculum details, explicit Socratic pedagogy, and stronger parent-formation programs.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly articulate and publish a Great Books program and a Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across grade levels, with a clear cross-disciplinary plan. Include direct references to primary texts, canonical authors, and a regular Great Conversation sequence in the curriculum pages and promotional materials.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit, school-wide documentation of pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning days, recitation/memory work, and upper-school rhetoric/deliberative speech) with example units and sample teacher moves. Include a public-facing Pedagogy Guide or “Classroom in Practice” page that demonstrates how classical methods are implemented in K–12.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Develop and publish formal parent-formation programs (e.g., classical book clubs, study guides, parent lectures) and strengthen explicit “parents as co-teachers” messaging. Create a visible open-door policy and a scheduled cadence of parent education events to reinforce the partnership in formation and culture.
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): If the school intends to deepen the theologic dimension in its classical framework, publish a public theology-integrated plan (even if ecumenical) showing how theology informs the curriculum and community life, and consider occasional liturgical or contemplative practices (even if optional) to strengthen communal worship/rituals in alignment with liturgical practices.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen and publish a formal “living curriculum” portrait of the ideal teacher and a teacher-formation program that includes mentor-teaching, continuous professional development in classical pedagogy, and a documented faculty profile/performance framework.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): While formation is strong, more explicit articulation of long-term telos (the ultimate aims beyond civic virtue) and the integration of wisdom standards across grades could reinforce the CLASSICAL orientation.

ABSTRACT

St. Johns Classical Academy Florida demonstrates a robust classical orientation in foundational aims (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Western classical tradition) and a formation-centered purpose (formation of mind and character; intelligent, virtuous citizens). The faculty messaging aligns with the classical ideal of teachers as virtuous models and living curriculum. Public materials show some classical pedagogy signals (notably the reference to Great Conversations) and a generally thoughtful, discussion-focused culture. However, explicit articulation of core classical curricular milestones (Great Books; Seven Liberal Arts), comprehensive, school-wide classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, Scholé), liturgical/community practices, and formal parent-formation programs are less evident in the available public materials. Taken together, SJCA lands in the category SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with some CLASSICAL strengths in Foundational Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Faculty, and opportunities to more fully codify and publicly publish the remaining elements of a full classical program.

- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Primary strengths: Clear formation-focused mission; explicit truth/goodness/beauty orientation; virtuous-culture framing; teachers as models and living curriculum; evidence of classical elements in “Great Conversations” scheduling and Western-tradition emphasis.
- Primary opportunities for needle-moving improvements: concrete articulation of a full Great Books / Trivium curriculum; explicit, school-wide classical pedagogy; visible liturgical/communal practice; formal parent-formation and parent-co-teaching structures; and a formal “faculty living curriculum” framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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